

Purpose: To help us look to Jesus Christ as “the bread of life,” the source of everlasting life ([John 6:47-48](#)).

1. Jesus heals a man on the Sabbath and declares himself the Son of God.

- Read [John 5](#).
- John 5:1-9. “Now there is at Jerusalem by the sheep market a pool, which is called ... Bethesda”.
“Some have been burdened by sins, by spiritual diseases for so great a time that they begin to lose hope of escape as did the man by the pool. Then, suddenly without solicitation, the Savior came and he was made clean and whole. Surely the Savior will do the same for all those who build faith and wait patiently for His help and assistance.” (Ted L. Gibbons, [NT Lesson #12](#))
- John 5:10-15. Jesus said, “Behold, thou art made whole: sin no more, lest a worse thing come unto thee.”
In what ways are the effects of sin “a worse thing” than physical infirmities?
- John 5:16-18. The “Jews ... sought to slay him, because he had done these things on the Sabbath day.”
- John 5:19-23, 30. “I seek not mine own will, but the will of the Father which hath sent me.”
- John 5:21-29. What are the greater works that Jesus referred to in verse 20?
- John 5:32-39, 45-47. Another “that beareth witness of me”. “Search the scriptures; ... they are they which testify of me.”
Why is it important to have these witnesses? (See [Jacob 4:6](#).)
What is the difference between searching the scriptures and reading them?
How have you made your personal and family scripture study more meaningful?
How have the scriptures strengthened your faith in Christ?
- John 5:40. “And ye will not come to me, that ye might have life.”

2. Jesus miraculously feeds more than 5,000 people.

- Read [John 6:1-14](#) and [Mark 6:30-44](#). (See the Mark 6:31 footnote *a*, which says they went to a *solitary* place.)
How did Jesus respond when the multitude came to him?
How can we follow the example of the boy who gave his loaves and fishes to Jesus?
How does the Lord bless us when we, like the boy, give whatever we have in His service?
- †1. Elder James E. Faust
- What are some examples you have seen of people being magnified by the Lord as they have served him?
How is the miraculous feast from five loaves and two fishes symbolic of the spiritual feast the Savior offers?

3. Jesus walks on the sea, invites Peter to come to him, and calms the winds.

- Read [John 6:15-21](#) and [Matthew 14:22-33](#).
- How did Jesus respond to their fears?
Why did Peter’s faith falter as he walked on the water?
How do we sometimes make similar errors when difficulties arise?
What does Peter’s response to sinking teach us about our relationship with the Lord?
How have you felt the Savior strengthen you and calm your fears?

4. Jesus declares that he is “the bread of life.”

- Read [John 6:22-71](#). †2. Elder Jeffrey R. Holland †3. Elder Jeffrey R. Holland
How is “bread of life” a good description of the Savior and the blessings he offers us? (See John 6:35, 47-51)
What does it mean to “never hunger” and “never thirst”?
How can we partake of the “bread of life”? (See John 6:47, 51-54; [Matthew 26:26-28](#); [Alma 5:33-35](#); [D&C 20:77](#).)
- †4. President Howard W. Hunter †5. Ted L. Gibbons †6. Ted L. Gibbons

“Some people did not believe Jesus because they saw him only as ‘the son of Joseph’ ([John 6:42](#)). Some who had claimed to be Jesus’ disciples murmured and turned away from him, saying that they did not understand the spiritual meanings of his declaration that he was the bread of life and his teaching about the need to eat his flesh and drink his blood ([John 6:51-66](#)). (*Lesson Manual*)

- John 6:67-69. “Will ye also go away?”

Next Week: L13 “I Will Give unto Thee the Keys of the Kingdom”; See L13: [Class Member Study Guide](#).
(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

†1. **Elder James E. Faust:** “Many nameless people with gifts equal only to five loaves and two small fishes magnify their callings and serve without attention or recognition, feeding literally thousands... These are the hundreds of thousands of leaders and teachers in all of the auxiliaries and priesthood quorums, the home teachers, the Relief Society visiting teachers. These are the many humble bishops in the Church, some without formal training but greatly magnified, always learning, with a humble desire to serve the Lord and the people of their wards...

“A major reason this church has grown from its humble beginnings to its current strength is the faithfulness and devotion of millions of humble and devoted people who have only five loaves and two small fishes to offer in the service of the Master. They have largely surrendered their own interests and in so doing have found ‘the peace of God, which passeth all understanding’ (Philippians 4:7)” (“[Five Loaves and Two Fishes](#),” *Ensign*, May 1994, 5-6).

†2. **Elder Jeffrey R. Holland:** “During the Savior’s Galilean ministry, He chided those who had heard of Him feeding the 5,000 with only five barley loaves and two fishes, and now flocked to him expecting a free lunch. That food, important as it was, was incidental to the real nourishment He was trying to give them” (“[He Hath Filled the Hungry with Good Things](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1997, 65).

†3. **Elder Jeffrey Holland:** “Some time ago I read an essay referring to ‘metaphysical hunger’ [1] The author was suggesting that the souls of men and women were dying, so to speak from lack of spiritual nourishment in our time. That phrase, ‘metaphysical hunger,’ came back to me last month when I read the many richly deserved tributes paid to Mother Teresa of Calcutta. One correspondent recalled her saying that as severe and wrenching as physical hunger was in our day—something she spent virtually her entire life trying to alleviate—nevertheless, she believed that the absence of spiritual strength, the paucity of spiritual nutrition, was an even more terrible hunger in the modern world.

“These observations reminded me of the chilling prophecy from the prophet Amos, who said so long ago, ‘Behold, the days come, saith the Lord God, that I will send a famine in the land, not a famine of bread, nor a thirst for water, but of hearing the words of the lord.’” [2] (“[He Hath Filled the Hungry with Good Things](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1997, 65).

†4. **President Howard W. Hunter:** “We must know Christ better than we know him; we must remember him more often than we remember him; we must serve him more valiantly than we serve him. Then we will drink water springing up unto eternal life and will eat the

bread of life” (“[What Manner of Men Ought Ye to Be?](#)” *Ensign*, May 1994, 64).

†5. **Ted L. Gibbons:** “The Savior has consistently, throughout recorded scriptural history, tried to link himself to the commonalities of our lives so that we will be reminded of him in the daily affairs of living. Thus he calls himself the [living water](#) (John 4:10-11); the [good shepherd](#) (John 10-11); the [stone or rock of Israel](#) (D&C 50:44); the [Light of the world](#) (John 8:12; 9:5); the [Lamb of God](#) (John 1:29) the [Cornerstone](#) (Ephesians 2:18-20); and, of course, the [Bread of Life](#) and the [Bread of Heaven](#) (John 6:35, 51). How often in your life do you see water, rocks or stones, light, and bread? How would your life be blessed if these images reminded you of the ministry and mission of the Redeemer? ([NT Lesson #12](#))

†6. **Ted L. Gibbons:** “Many of the blessings that come to us from the Savior come in unremarkable ways. He uses the tools and events of mortality to bless us and to teach us, and he does it so well that many times we are unaware that he has had a hand in our success or safety at all. But then those other, less common things occur.

“My wife and I had a movie of our wedding day, filmed and spliced and edited by a professional photographer and given to us for a gift. We treasured it. We watched it. We loved it. We lost it. We were in North Carolina in the Army and it disappeared. My wife was certain that it had been mistakenly placed into the garbage box rather than the storage box when she unpacked.

“But many years later, after a simple prayer and a hopeless longing, when I wanted it for a lesson, I found it in the top of a box of my father’s old photographic supplies that had not been opened since my father’s death, long before I was married. Some are skeptical, thinking that I made a mistake in North Carolina and that the movie was never there. But I was there. I know. As I know that Jesus walked on the water. As Gabriel said to Mary, “... with God nothing shall be impossible.” (Luke 1:37)” ([NT Lesson #12](#))

Recommended Reading:

1. Elder Jeffrey R. Holland, “[He Hath Filled the Hungry with Good Things](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1997.
2. Daniel Rona, [Hidden LDS/Jewish Insights](#), New Testament Gospel Doctrine Supplement 12.
3. Nancy Jensen, “[New Testament Lesson #12](#),” at LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, March 14, 2011.
4. Bruce Satterfield, “[Gospel Doctrine Lesson 12](#)” at Meridian Magazine, March 26, 2015.
5. Lenet H. Read, “[New Testament 12](#)”.

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